



THE REAL
DEPRESSION T_T

CHAPTER 1

THE MAN IN THE ROAD

It was exactly **12:00 midnight**.

The roads should have been almost empty at this hour. The city was quiet, the shops were closing, and most people were already asleep. I was driving home alone, watching the headlights of my car cut through the darkness.

I kept checking the clock on the dashboard.

12:01 AM.

I needed to get home quickly.

My grandmother wasn't feeling well tonight, and my family had been waiting for me to come back. She was old, and everyone was worried about her. I had promised that I would be home as soon as possible.

So naturally, the universe decided to make my night worse. At first, I noticed a few red brake lights ahead of me.

Then a few more.

Then hundreds.

I slowed down.

Cars were packed across the road.

A bus was barely moving.

A truck was stuck between two lanes.

People were honking everywhere.

HONK. HONK. HONK.

I stared at the traffic in disbelief. "You've got to be kidding me." I moved forward a few meters. Stopped. Moved again. Stopped. Nothing. The traffic wasn't moving. I looked at the clock. 12:17 AM. "COME ON!" I hit the steering wheel with my palm.

I HATE TRAFFIC!

I was already late, and now I was trapped in the middle of what looked like the biggest traffic jam I had ever seen. I leaned forward, trying to figure out what had happened.

Was there an accident?

Was the road closed?

Was there construction?

Then I noticed something strange.

People weren't looking at the cars.

They were looking **toward the middle of the road.**

I frowned. "What are they staring at?" I slowly rolled my window down. Rain began falling onto the glass. I could hear people shouting outside. "What is happening?" "Why isn't anyone moving?" "Who put that there?" I couldn't see clearly through all the cars. So I switched lanes and slowly moved closer.

And then—

I saw him.

There was a man sitting on a chair.

In the middle of the road.

Not beside the road.

Not on the sidewalk.

Not in a parked vehicle.

Literally in the middle of the road.

And he wasn't doing anything that made sense.

He was sitting at a wooden desk.

In front of him was an old, bulky computer with a huge CRT monitor glowing through the rain. A keyboard was sitting on the desk. A mouse. A strange collection of cables. And, for some reason... **RGB lights**. I stared at the scene. Cars were stuck behind him. Drivers were leaning out of their windows. People were taking pictures. A police officer was walking toward him. And the man?

He didn't seem to care about any of it.

He was completely focused on his screen.

Typing.

Click.

Click.

Click.

I blinked.

"...Is that a computer?" I looked again. It was. An actual computer. In the middle of the road. At midnight. During the rain. With an entire traffic jam forming around it.

I slowly lowered my window even further. Then I heard the strangest thing. The man suddenly shouted at his computer:

"WHY IS LINE 99,999,999 STILL BROKEN?!"

I froze.

What?

I looked at the hundreds of cars behind me. Then at the police officer. Then back at the man. My grandmother was waiting for me at home. I needed to get through this traffic. But now I had a much bigger question.

Who was this man...and why was he coding in the middle of the road?



ROADSIDE CODER IS A SUBJECT TO THE MARKET RISKS, PLEASE READ ALL THE DOCUMENTS CAREFULLY BEFORE INVESTING!

MRP : RS. 50

PART 2 WILL BE LAUNCHED AFTER A GOOD SALE :)